



Endpoint Protection (Core)

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Coding Dojo Cybersecurity Boot Camp
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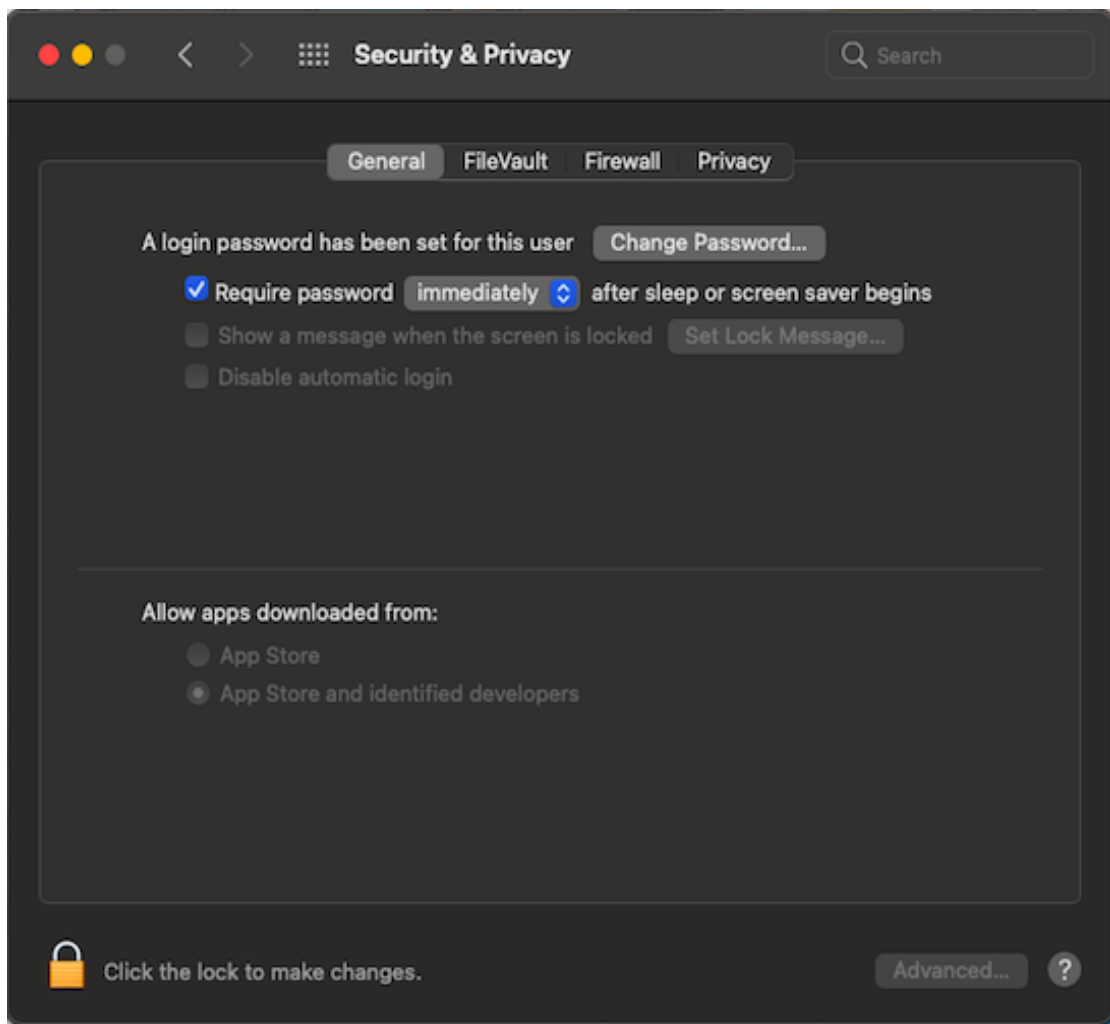
Assignment Submission

Create a Word or Google sheet document that shows your enabled endpoint protection (screenshot of the settings being changed) and write a brief summary discussing the pros and cons of having this much security.

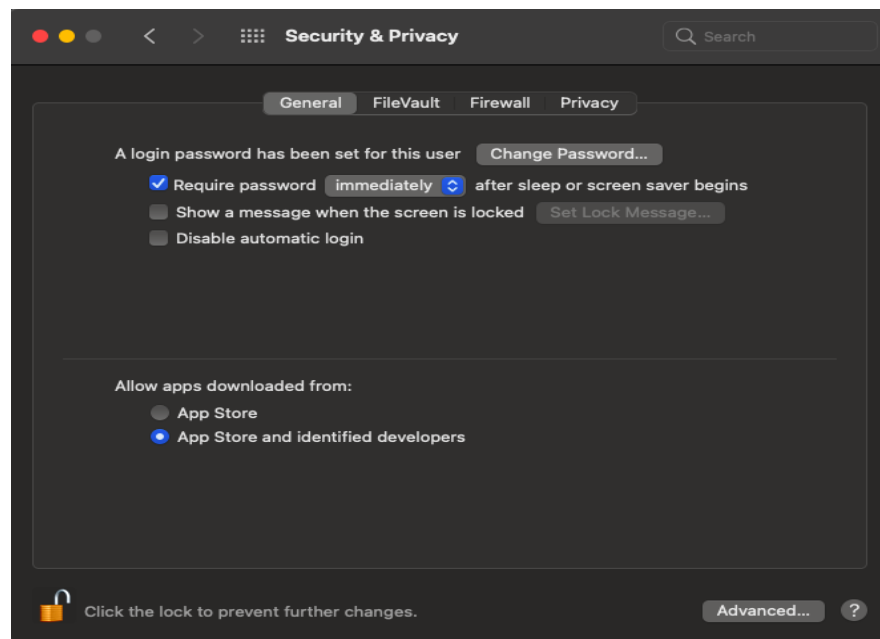
Assignment Solution:

- Confirm status of endpoint protection:

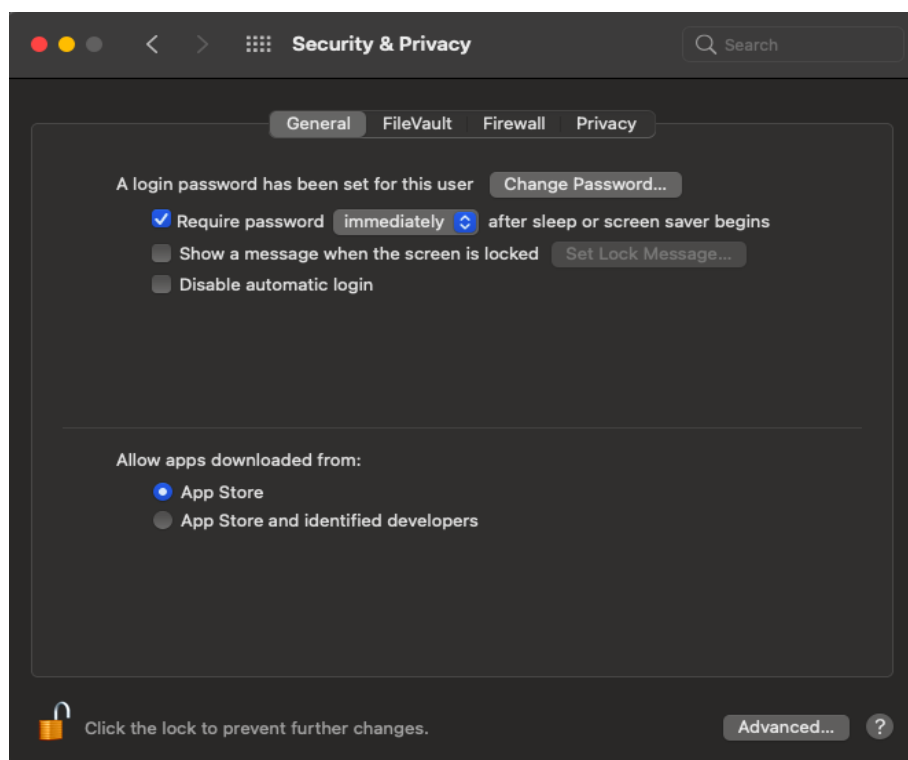
Endpoint protection is disabled here, as download of Apps from both the App store and identified developers are allowed.



- Click the Lock in order to unlock the settings; to enable endpoint protection:

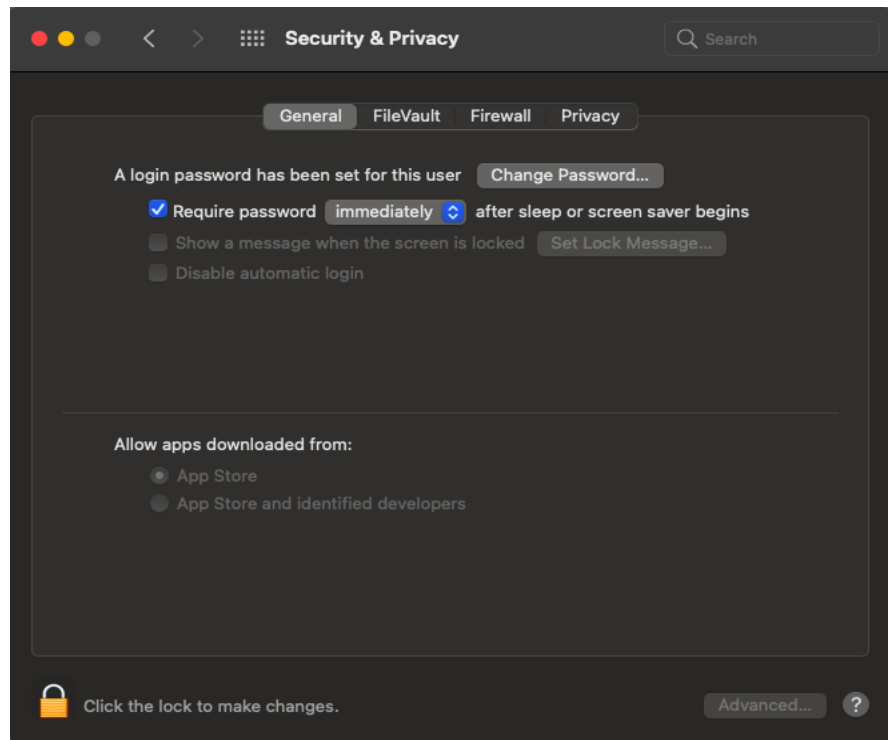


- Select the 'App Store' option:

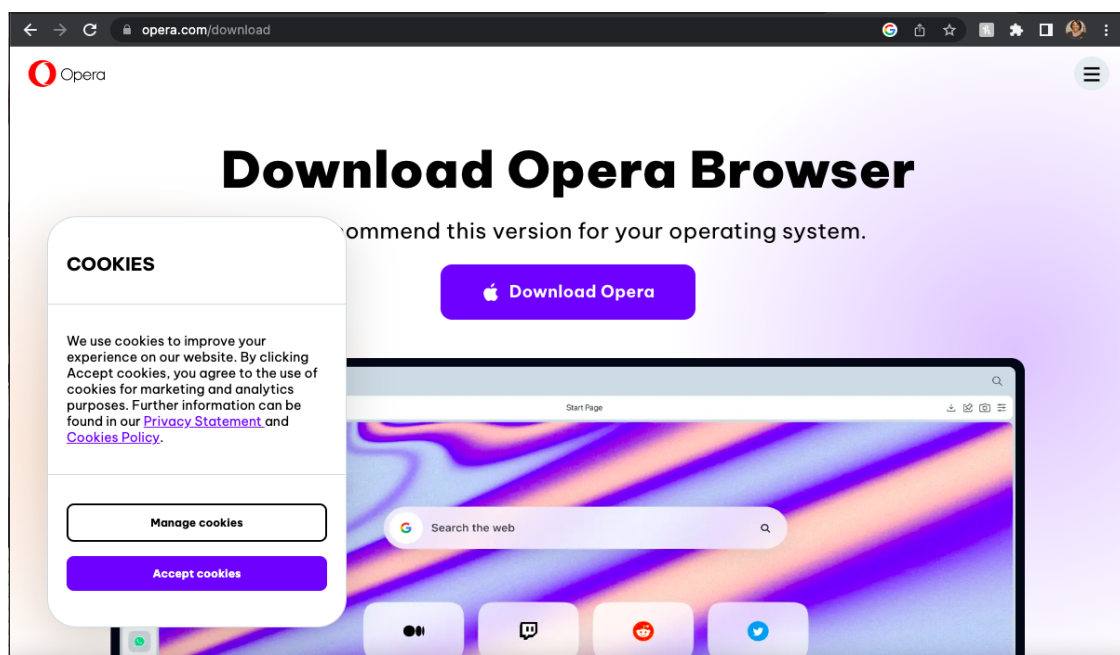


- Click the Lock to prevent further changes. This is to enable the endpoint protection:

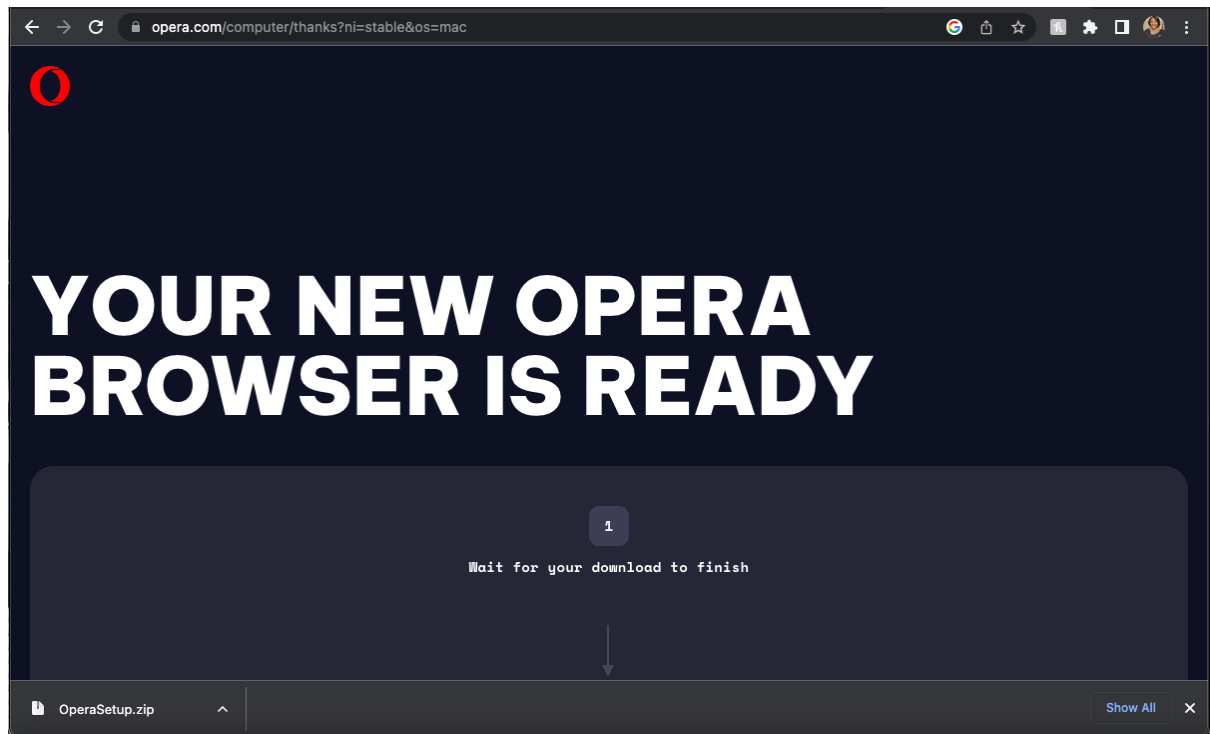




Now, that endpoint protection has been enabled, attempt to download Opera from the downloads page:



- Download the Opera Installer:

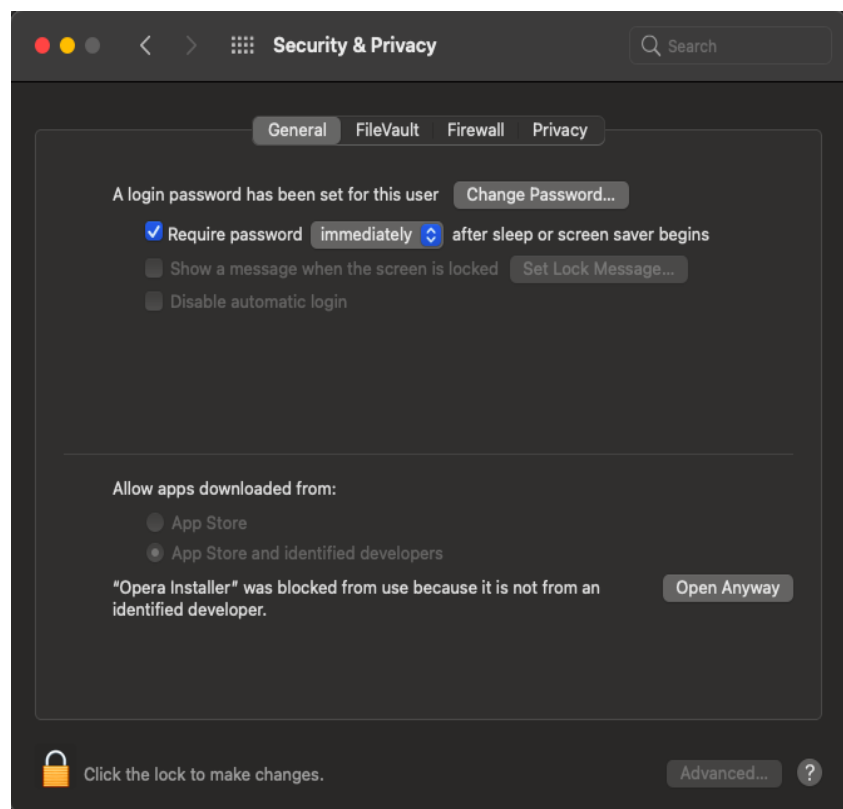
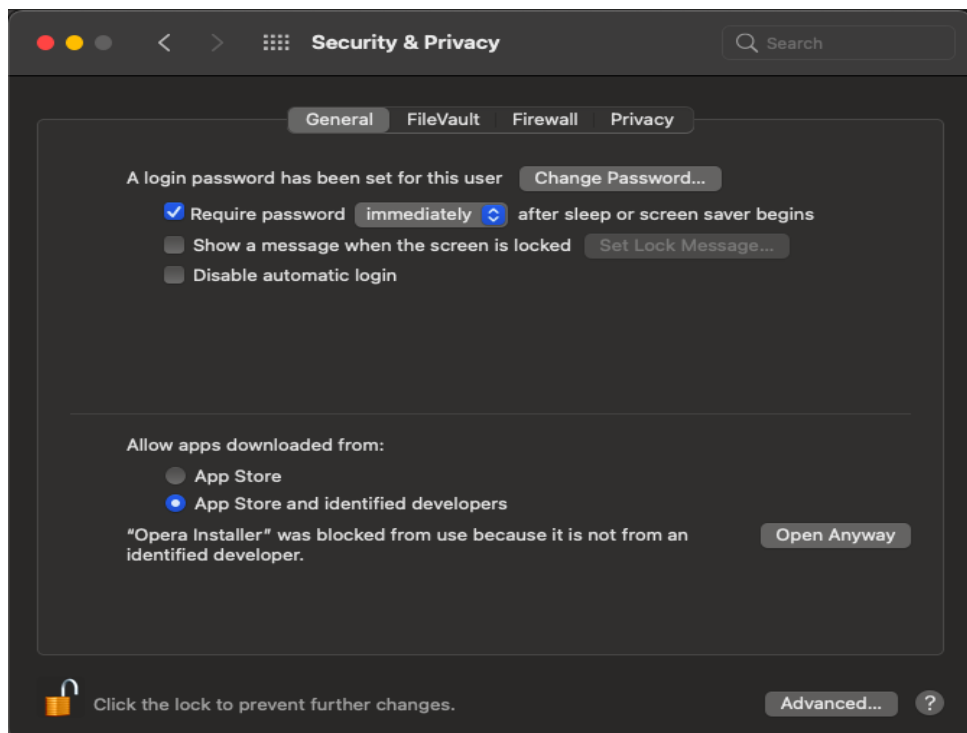


- Run the downloader installer to install the app. The message below is displayed:



This ensures that applications that are not from the App store cannot be installed directly on the system.

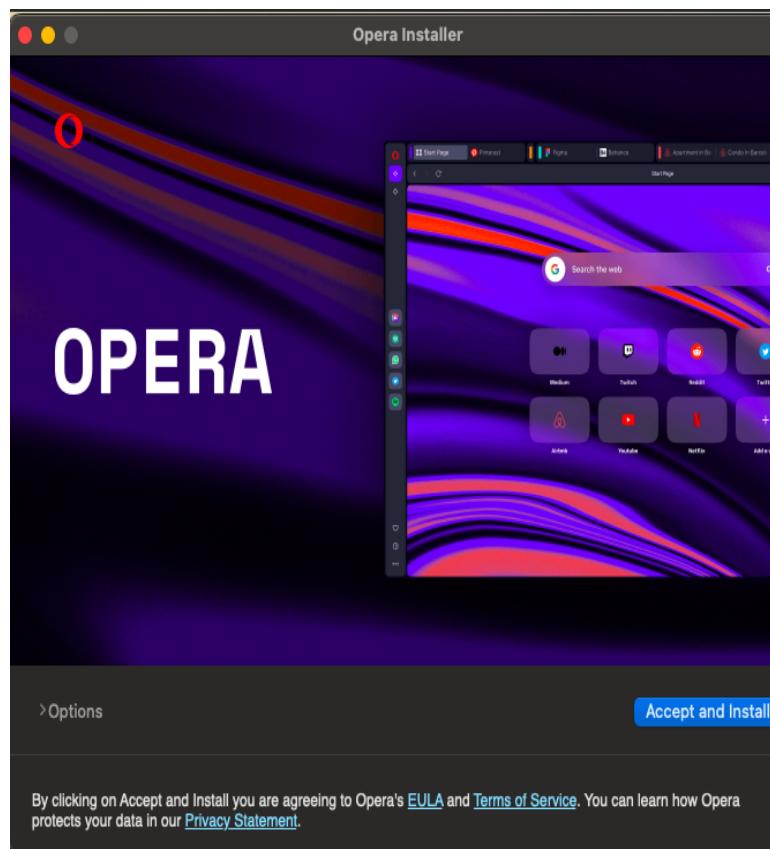
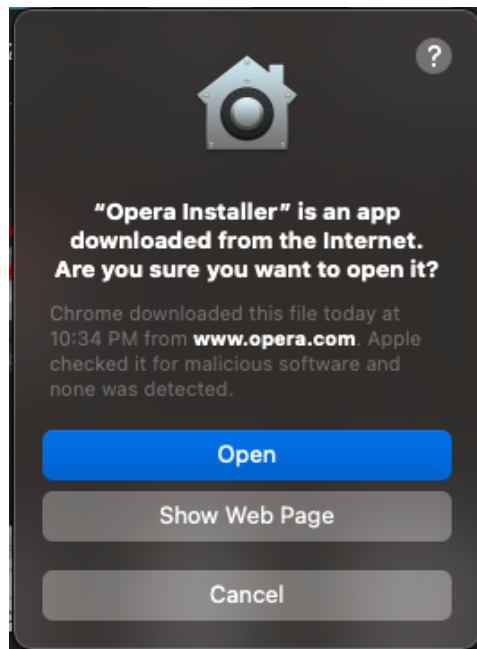
- Disable endpoint protection and let's review the effect on the installation of Apps that are not from the App Store:



Endpoint protection has been disabled.

- Now, run the opera installer to install the App:





The Opera App was successfully installed.

This shows that applications from unknown sources can be installed once the endpoint protection has been disabled. This is security challenge.



Pros and Cons of Endpoint Protection

This option of enabling endpoint protection has its advantages which includes:

1. Since Applications available on the App store undergo a vetting process by the platform provider, which involves checking for security vulnerabilities & adherence to policies, this helps ensure that the apps available for download are less likely to contain malicious code.
2. By limiting app installations to those from the App store, the risk of downloading and installing malicious or compromised apps is significantly reduced.
3. Apps distributed through app stores are more likely to receive regular security updates, enhancing the overall security of the installed apps.

These tend to protect the Confidentiality, Integrity and availability of data which could otherwise be compromised if applications from unknown sources can be installed.

On the flip side, enabling endpoint protection has its cons, which includes:

1. A hindrance to accessing applications that are not available in the App store, i.e. a restriction for choice of Applications, even for legitimate purposes.
2. Due to the default assumption that all apps in the App store are seemingly secure, this may give a false sense of security, thereby leading to less cautious behavior by users.
3. Threat actors may define more sophisticated tricky means of cyberattacks through applications available in the App stores.
4. If there's a slip of malware through any application in the App stores, it potentially gets downloaded blindly by users. (I believe this is where another level protection should be available to mitigate these kinds of risks. E.g. Antivirus, etc.)